

Ethiopia

Ratio: 1:2 **Adopted:** February 6, 1996 **Usage:** National and Civil

The colors date back to the 19th century

Red is symbolic of strength



Green recalls the land and hope for the future

Yellow is the color of peace and love

The emblem represents diversity and unity

Africa



Ethiopia was recognized as an empire in the 19th century. It was occupied by Italy from 1936–41. The Emperor was overthrown in 1974.

The three traditional colors: green, yellow, and red date back to the Emperor Menelik (1889–1913) and were first used in a flag in 1895.

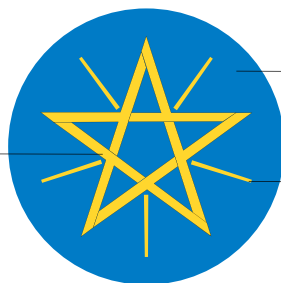
The current flag and emblem were adopted after the defeat of the Marxist Mengistu regime, in power from 1974–1991. The emblem is intended to represent both the diversity and unity of the country.

ETHIOPIA AND THE RASTAFARI

In the 1930s the Ethiopian colors became popular with black activists in Jamaica who looked to Ethiopia for political and spiritual guidance. Since then, these colors (along with black from the flag of Marcus Garvey) have become linked with the Rastafarian movement, and have spread to other African countries.

EMBLEM OF ETHIOPIA

The star represents diversity and unity



Blue represents peace

The sun's rays symbolize prosperity